



MEDICAL NUTRITION THERAPY IN MUSCULOSKELETAL & SPORTS REHABILITATION

WHAT IS MEDICAL NUTRITION THERAPY (MNT)?

Medical Nutrition Therapy is an evidence-based, individualized approach to managing health conditions through nutrition. It's not about generic diet advice or trendy fads. MNT is delivered by a **registered dietitian (RD)** or a **clinical nutritionist** who has the expertise to assess your specific nutritional needs, taking into account your medical history, current health status, activity level, and rehabilitation goals.

WHY IS MNT PARTICULARLY IMPORTANT FOR MUSCULOSKELETAL AND SPORTS REHABILITATION?

Injuries, intense training, and surgical recovery place significant demands on your body's nutritional reserves.

- **Increased nutrient demands:** The healing process itself requires a substantial increase in calories, protein, and specific micronutrients. Without adequate intake, recovery can be prolonged and incomplete.
- **Inflammation management:** Chronic inflammation can delay healing and contribute to pain. Certain foods can exacerbate inflammation, while others can actively reduce it. MNT helps you navigate this.
- **Muscle protein synthesis:** For athletes and individuals recovering from injuries, building and repairing muscle is paramount. MNT ensures you're consuming enough high-quality protein at the right times to maximize muscle protein synthesis.
- **Bone health:** Stress fractures, osteoporosis, and general bone health are critical concerns. MNT can address calcium, Vitamin D, and other nutrient needs to support strong bones.
- **Gut health and nutrient absorption:** A healthy gut is crucial for absorbing the nutrients your body needs for recovery. MNT often addresses gut health to optimize nutrient utilization.
- **Sustainable performance:** Beyond recovery, MNT helps athletes maintain consistent energy, prevent overtraining, and support long-term performance.

YOUR ROADMAP TO RECOVERY: WHAT TO EXPECT FROM MEDICAL NUTRITION THERAPY

When you engage in MNT, in-person or online, you'll embark on a personalized journey designed to complement your physiotherapy OR fitness programs. Here's an overview of what to expect:

1. Initial assessment (The deep dive)

- **Comprehensive review:** Your dietitian will conduct a thorough review of your medical history, current injury or condition, medications, dietary habits, lifestyle, activity level, and rehabilitation goals.
- **Nutritional assessment:** This may involve a detailed diet recall, analysis of your usual eating patterns, and discussion about your food preferences, intolerances, or allergies.
- **Picture and measurement analysis:** Effective recovery programs rely on objective data, including specific limb measurements and baseline photography, to accurately assess body composition and validate long-term progress.
- **Blood work review:** Your dietitian may review recent lab results (e.g., Vitamin D levels, iron, inflammatory markers) to identify potential deficiencies or imbalances.



2. Goal setting & education (Understanding your "Why")



- Based on the assessment, you and your dietitian will collaboratively set realistic and achievable nutrition goals tailored to your specific needs and recovery phase.
- You'll receive clear, evidence-based education on the role of specific nutrients in your recovery, how food choices impact inflammation, energy levels, and overall healing.



3. Personalized nutrition plan development (Your custom blueprint)

Your dietitian will create a bespoke nutrition plan, not a rigid diet. This plan will be practical, sustainable, and integrate seamlessly with your existing lifestyle and rehabilitation schedule whether you are at home or travelling and engaging remotely.

This may include:

- Specific recommendations for macronutrients (proteins, carbohydrates, fats) to support healing and energy.
- Guidance on micronutrients (vitamins, minerals) and their role in your recovery.
- Meal timing strategies, especially around training and physiotherapy sessions.
- Hydration guidelines.
- Recommendations for targeted supplementation, if necessary, to address specific deficiencies (e.g., Vitamin D, Omega-3s, collagen), always with a focus on safety and efficacy.
- Practical meal and snack ideas, recipes, and portion guidance.



4. Ongoing monitoring & adjustment (Adapting to your progress)

- MNT is not a one-time consultation. You'll have follow-up sessions with your dietitian to monitor your progress, address any challenges, and make necessary adjustments to your plan based on your schedule or location changes as your recovery evolves.
- This ensures the plan remains effective and continues to support your changing needs as you move through different phases of rehabilitation – from acute injury to return to sport/activity.
- Your dietitian will work in close collaboration with your physiotherapists and SNC coaches to ensure a cohesive and synergistic approach to your recovery.



5. Empowerment & long-term health (Building sustainable habits)

- The ultimate goal of MNT is to empower you with the knowledge and skills to make informed food choices for life no matter your current lifestyle, work hours, or location.
- You'll learn how to interpret food labels, navigate challenging eating situations, and develop sustainable habits that support not just your recovery, but your overall health and well-being long after you've completed your rehabilitation.

THE PREHAB DIGICARE ADVANTAGE: INTEGRATED CARE

At PREHAB DigiCare, we believe in a holistic approach to your health. Integrating medical Nutrition Therapy with our renowned Physiotherapy and Strength & Conditioning services creates a powerful synergy. By optimizing your body's internal environment through nutrition, we enhance the effectiveness of every lunge, every rep, and every treatment session.